

Self-Hosting N8N using npx and Node.JS

The following instructions will guide you through the steps to install Node.JS and run N8N locally using npx.

✓ PART 1: Install Node.js (and npm)

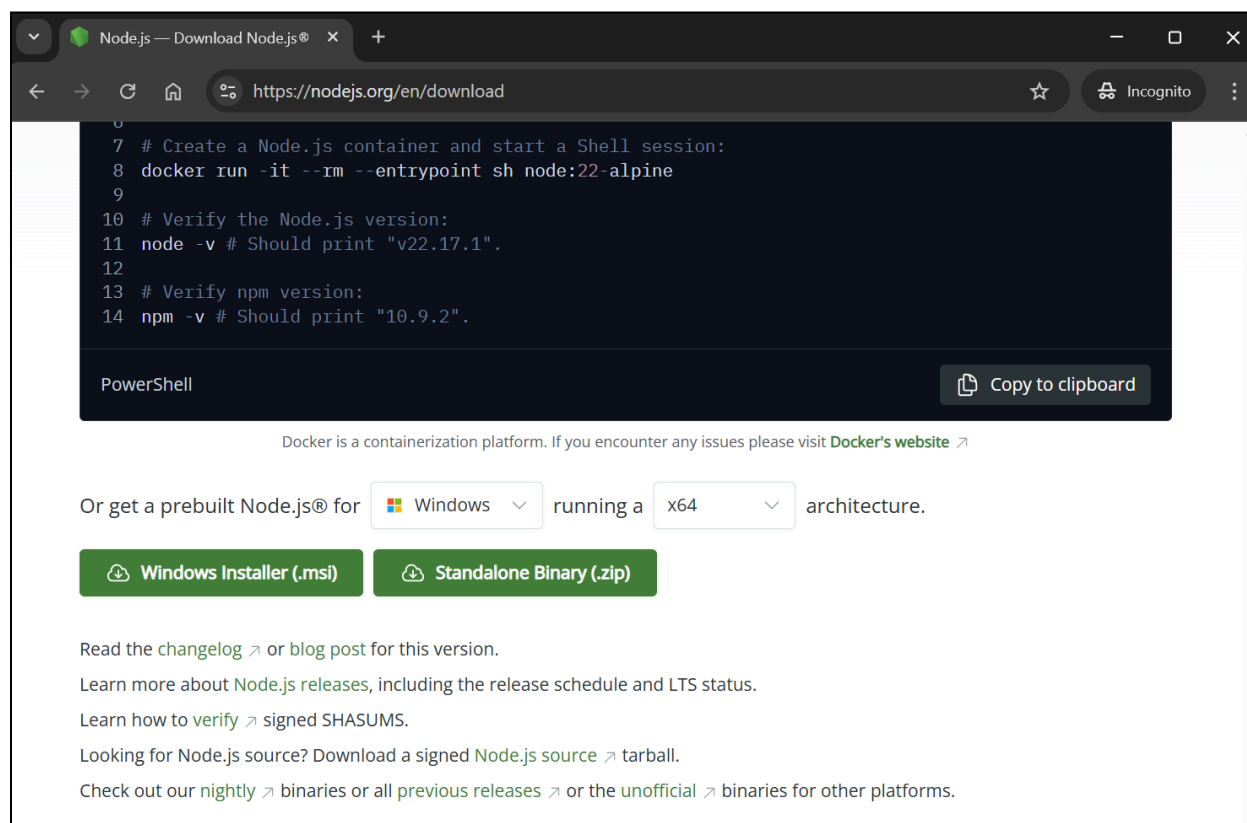
♦ Step 1: Go to the Node.js official website

Open your web browser and visit: <https://nodejs.org/en/download>

♦ Step 2: Download the LTS version

Select the prebuilt Node.JS installer by selecting the OS and the CPU architecture and click on the download button.

As shown in the image below, the prebuilt Node.JS selected is for a Windows-based machine that uses an Intel CPU (x64 architecture).



When selecting prebuilt Node.js binaries, you need to choose the correct version based on your system's architecture and operating system. The following table shows the system architecture for different types of machines.

Your Computer Type	Architecture	Which Node.JS version to choose
You are running a 64-bit version of Windows, macOS, or Linux (which is most modern systems)	AMD64 (also called x86_64 or x64)	Download x64 version
You are using a 32-bit OS (rare today)	x86 (32-bit)	Download x86 version
Devices with ARM64-based processors such as: • Apple M1/M2/M3 Macs (macOS on Apple Silicon). • Raspberry Pi 4/5 (running 64-bit OS). • Some Windows 11 ARM laptops/tablets (e.g., Surface Pro X).	ARM64	Download ARM64 version

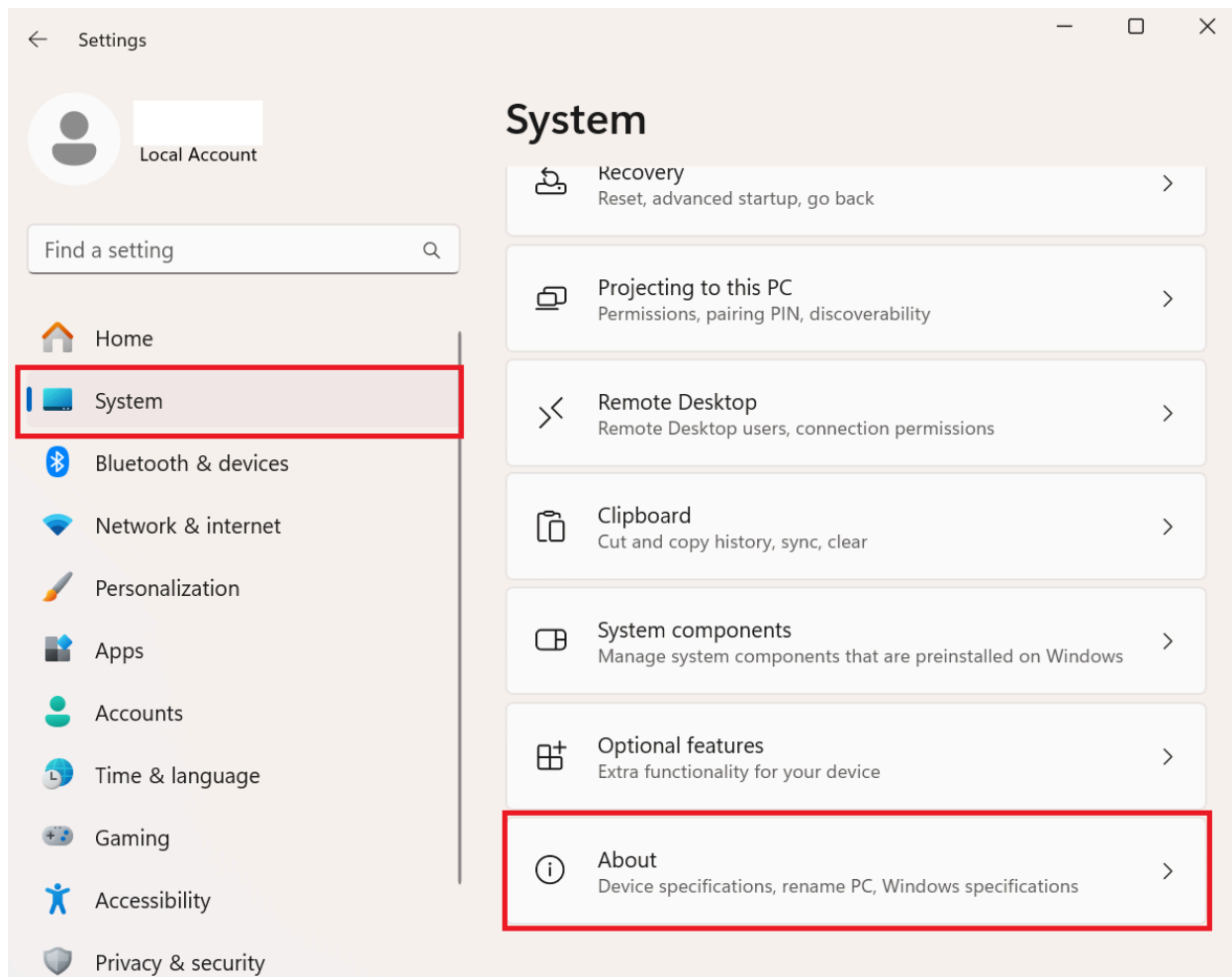
If you're unsure about the architecture of your Windows machine, refer to the instructions below. For Linux and Mac machines, please refer to the following resources:

- **For Linux Users** - How to find architecture of my PC and Ubuntu?
- **For Mac Users** - Determine the architecture of a Mac from the command line or script? - Super User

Check System Architecture in Windows

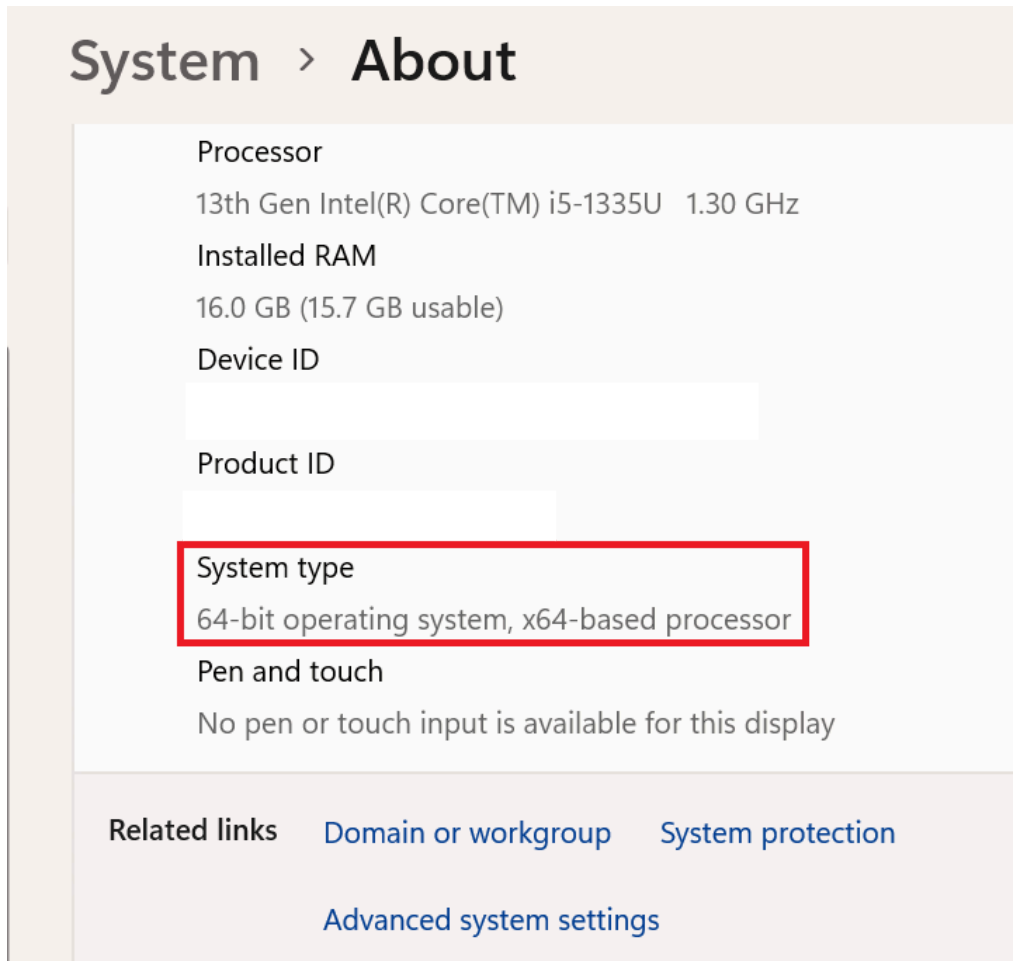
Following are the instructions to check the system architecture in Windows Settings.

- Press Windows + I to open Settings. Go to System > About.



Under Device specifications, look at System type

- If it says x64-based processor, you're using **AMD64**.
- If it says ARM-based processor, you're using **ARM64**.

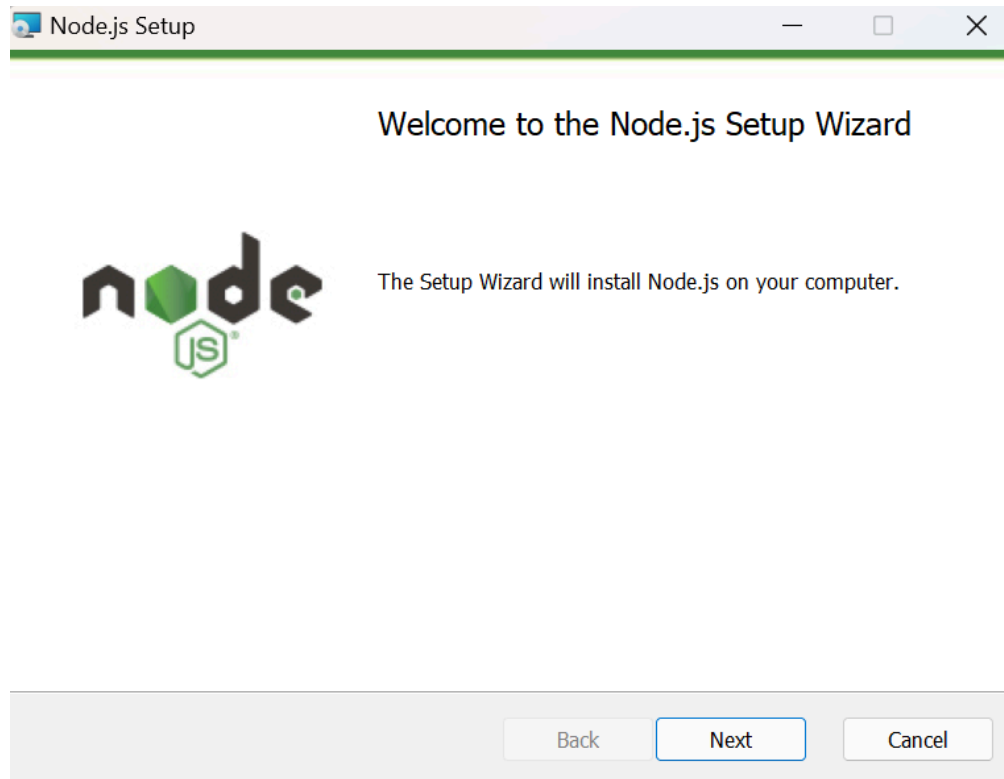


Once you've downloaded the correct pre-built binaries, proceed with installing Node.JS software.

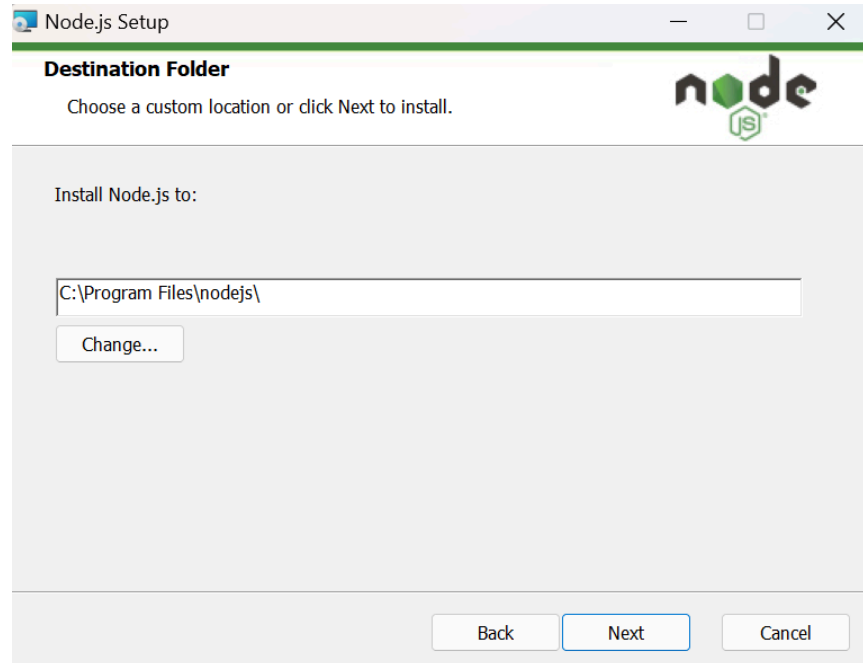
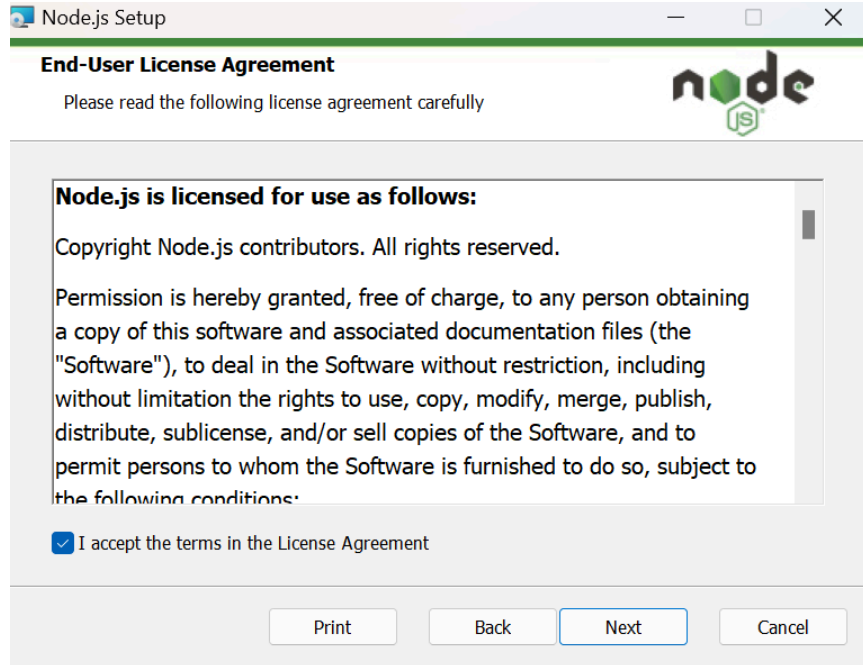
♦ **Step 3: Run the installer**

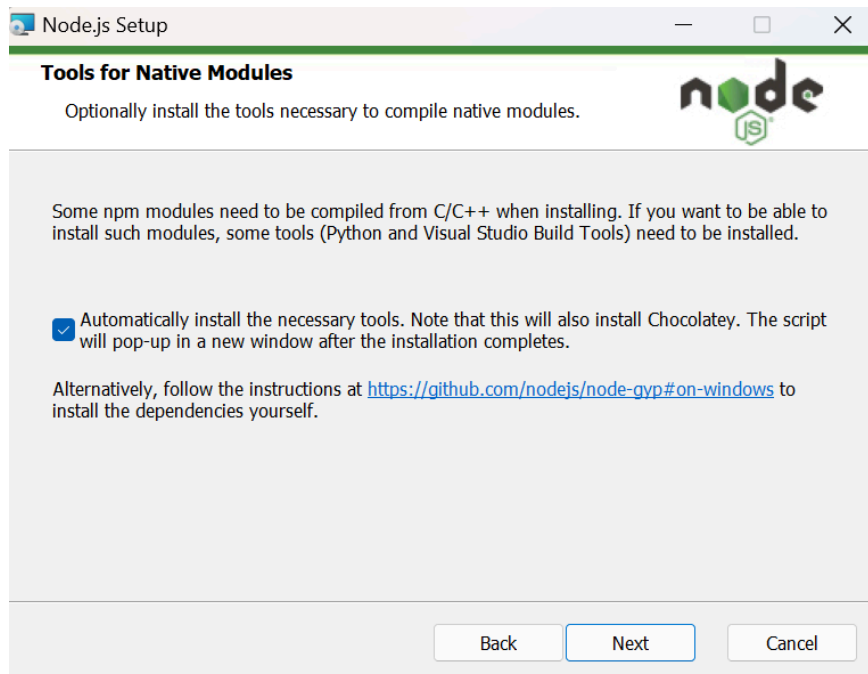
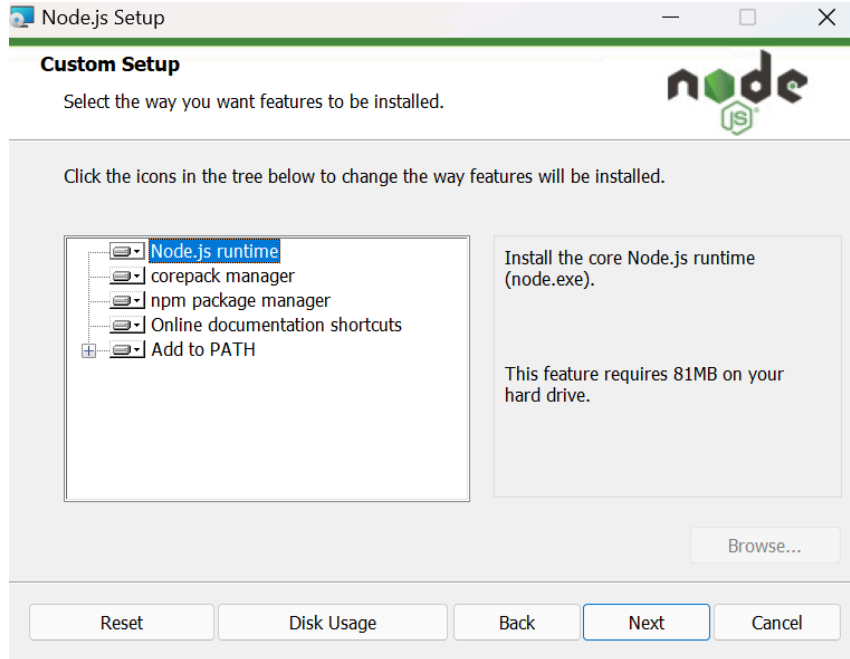
After downloading:

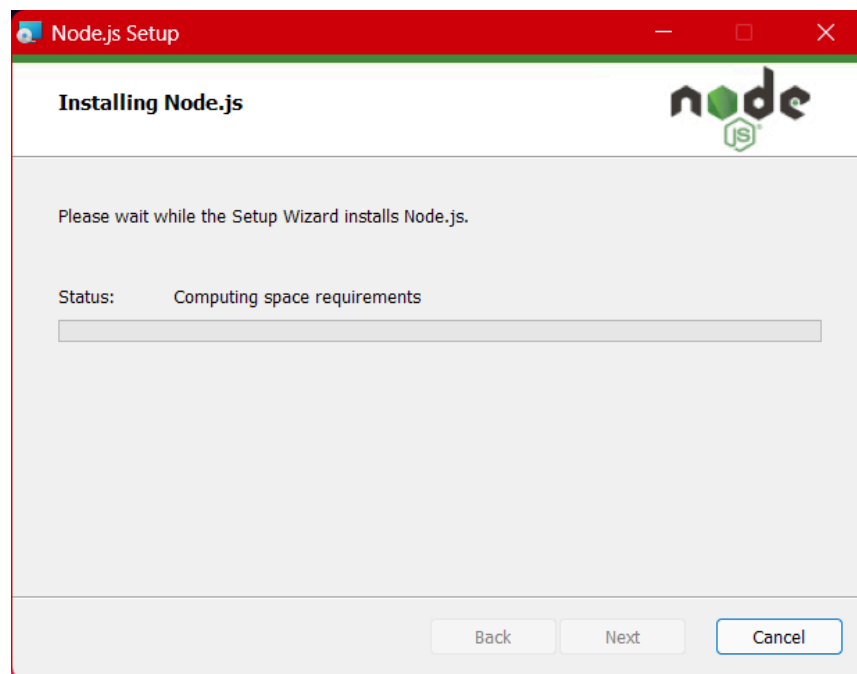
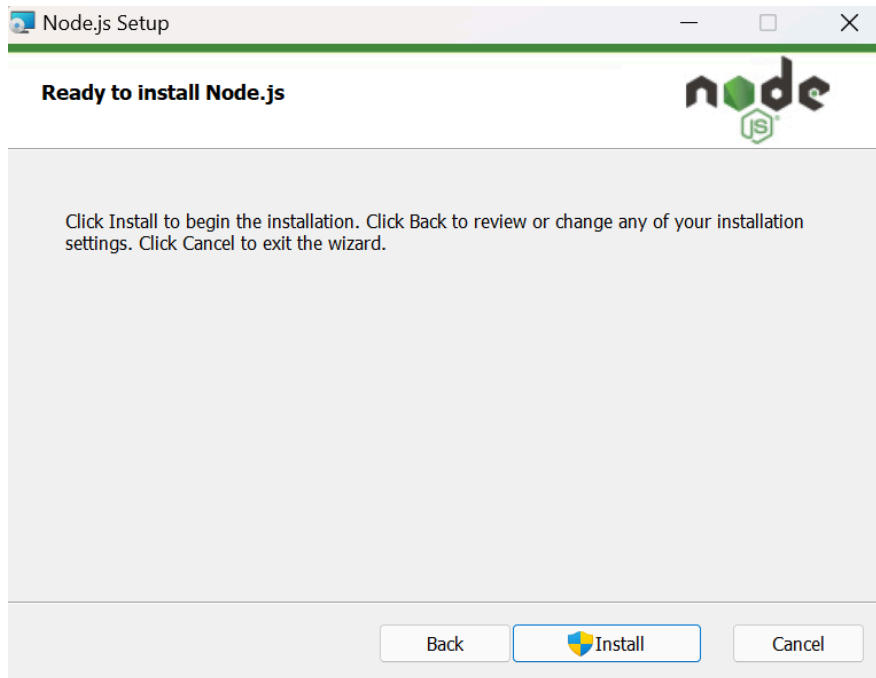
- Double-click the installer file (e.g., node-v20.x.x-x64.msi)
- Click Next through the installation steps

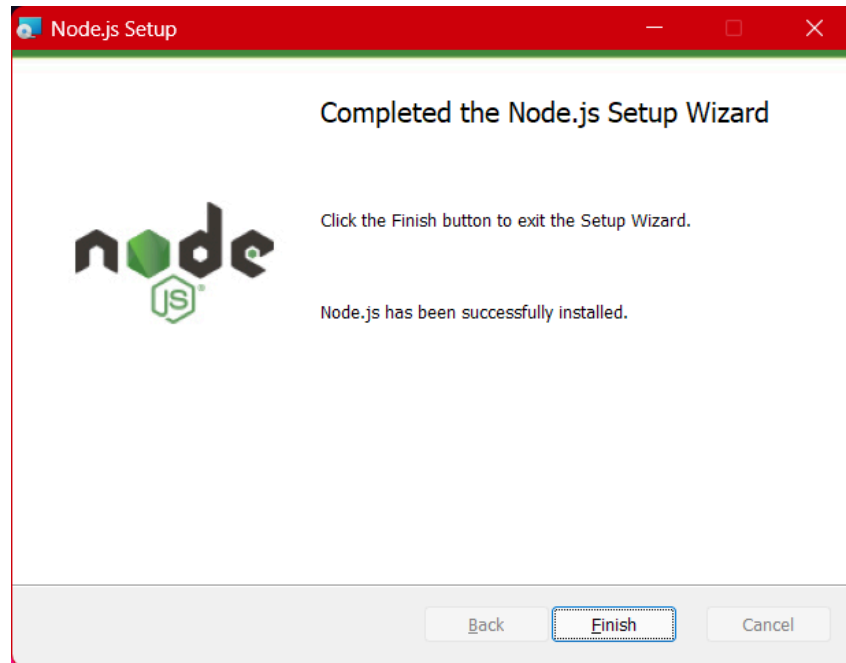


- Keep everything default unless you know what you're changing









Click on the Start Menu and click on the option for Node.JS

```
Install Additional Tools for Node.js Native Modules Installation Script

This script will install Python and the Visual Studio Build Tools, necessary
to compile Node.js native modules. Note that Chocolatey and required Windows
updates will also be installed.

This will require about 3 GiB of free disk space, plus any space necessary to
install Windows updates. This will take a while to run.

Please close all open programs for the duration of the installation. If the
installation fails, please ensure Windows is fully updated, reboot your
computer and try to run this again. This script can be found in the
Start menu under Node.js.

You can close this window to stop now. Detailed instructions to install these
tools manually are available at https://github.com/nodejs/node-gyp#on-windows

Press any key to continue . . . |
```

```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
WARNING: 'choco' was found at 'C:\ProgramData\chocolatey\bin\choco.exe'.
WARNING: An existing Chocolatey installation was detected. Installation will not continue. This script will not
overwrite existing installations.
If there is no Chocolatey installation at 'C:\ProgramData\chocolatey', delete the folder and attempt the installation
again.

Please use choco upgrade chocolatey to handle upgrades of Chocolatey itself.
If the existing installation is not functional or a prior installation did not complete, follow these steps:
- Backup the files at the path listed above so you can restore your previous installation if needed.
- Remove the existing installation manually.
- Rerun this installation script.
- Reinstall any packages previously installed, if needed (refer to the lib folder in the backup).

Once installation is completed, the backup folder is no longer needed and can be deleted.
chocolatey v2.3.0
3 validations performed. 2 success(es), 1 warning(s), and 0 error(s).

Validation Warnings:
- A pending system reboot request has been detected, however, this is
being ignored due to the current Chocolatey configuration. If you
want to halt when this occurs, then either set the global feature
using:
  choco feature enable --name="exitOnRebootDetected"
or pass the option --exit-when-reboot-detected.

Upgrading the following packages:
python;visualstudio2019-workload-vctools
By upgrading, you accept licenses for the packages.

You have python v3.12.6 installed. Version 3.13.5 is available based on your source(s).
```

◆ Step 4: Verify installation

Open Command Prompt:

Press Windows + R, type cmd, and press Enter

Type the following:

```
Shell
node -v
```

This should print the installed version like:

```
Shell
v20.10.0
```

```
Shell
npm -v
```

This should print a version like as shown below:

```
Shell
10.2.3
```

You're now ready to use npx (it comes with npm).

✓ **PART 2: Run n8n Locally Using npx**

This lets you run n8n temporarily, without installing it globally.

- ♦ Step 1: Create a new folder (optional but clean)

In Command Prompt, run the following commands:

```
Shell
mkdir n8n-local
cd n8n-local
```

- ♦ Step 2: Run n8n using npx

In the terminal, type:

```
Shell
npm install n8n -g
```

The first time, it will download n8n. It might take a few minutes.

Open Command Prompt and run the following command

```
Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22631.5189]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\henry>npm install n8n -g
```

```
Command Prompt

npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated gauge@4.0.4: This package is no longer supported.
npm warn deprecated gm@1.25.1: The gm module has been sunset. Please migrate to an alternative. https://github.com/aheckmann/gm?tab=readme-ov-file#2025-02-24-this-project-is-not-maintained
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated lodash.get@4.4.2: This package is deprecated. Use the optional chaining (?.) operator instead.
npm warn deprecated @aws-sdk/signature-v4@3.374.0: This package has moved to @smithy/signature-v4
npm warn deprecated @aws-sdk/protocol-http@3.374.0: This package has moved to @smithy/protocol-http
npm warn deprecated rimraf@2.6.3: Rimraf versions prior to v4 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated glob@7.2.3: Glob versions prior to v9 are no longer supported
npm warn deprecated infisical-node@1.3.0: Package no longer supported. Contact Support at https://www.npmjs.com/support for more info.

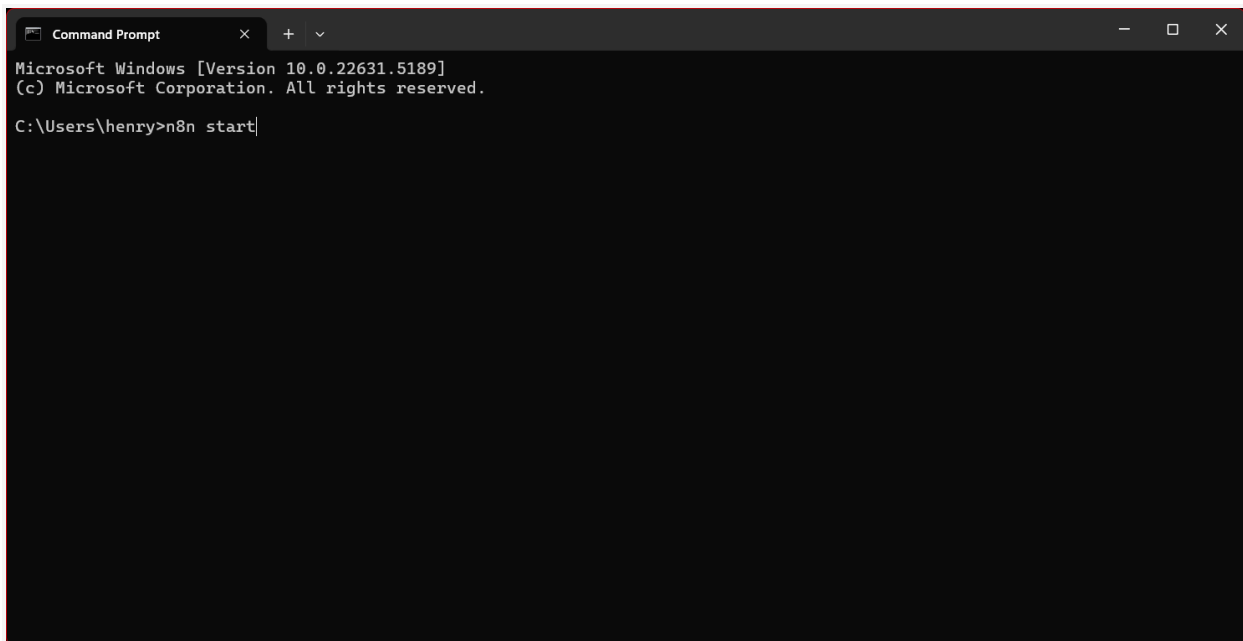
added 1952 packages in 3m

228 packages are looking for funding
  run `npm fund` for details
npm notice
npm notice New major version of npm available! 10.9.2 -> 11.4.2
npm notice Changelog: https://github.com/npm/cli/releases/tag/v11.4.2
npm notice To update run: npm install -g npm@11.4.2
npm notice

C:\Users\henry>
```

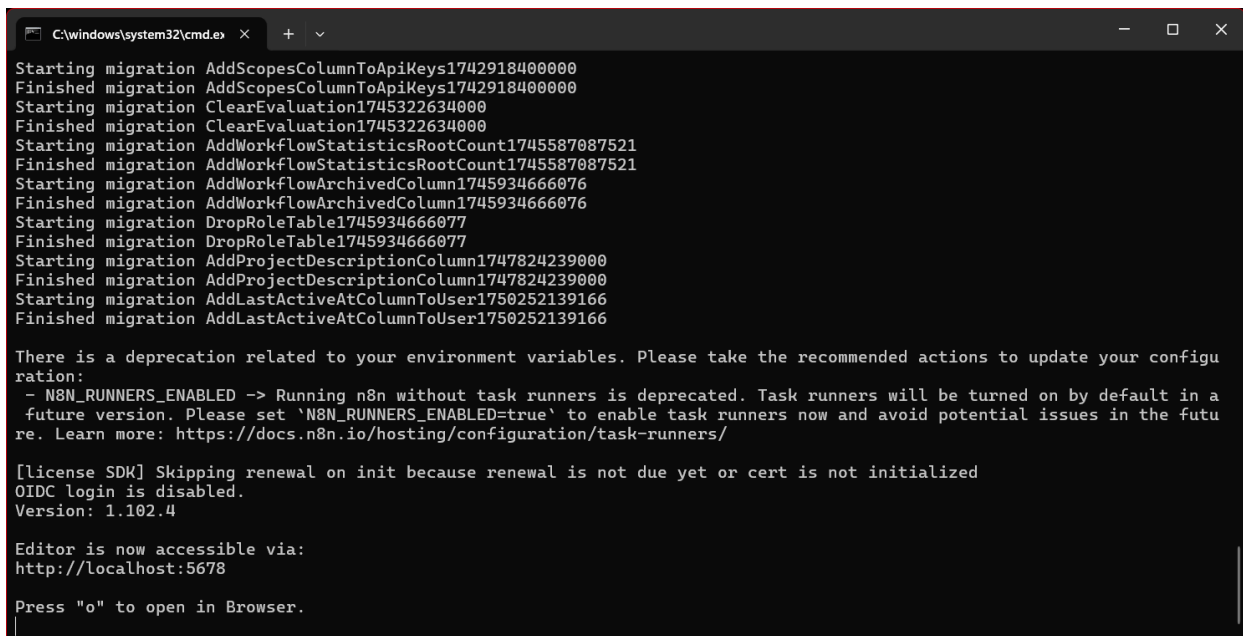
After the installation, start n8n by running:

```
Shell
n8n
# or
n8n start
```



```
Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22631.5189]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\henry>n8n start
```



```
C:\windows\system32\cmd.exe
Starting migration AddScopesColumnToApiKeys1742918400000
Finished migration AddScopesColumnToApiKeys1742918400000
Starting migration ClearEvaluation1745322634000
Finished migration ClearEvaluation1745322634000
Starting migration AddWorkflowStatisticsRootCount1745587087521
Finished migration AddWorkflowStatisticsRootCount1745587087521
Starting migration AddWorkflowArchivedColumn1745934666076
Finished migration AddWorkflowArchivedColumn1745934666076
Starting migration DropRoleTable1745934666077
Finished migration DropRoleTable1745934666077
Starting migration AddProjectDescriptionColumn1747824239000
Finished migration AddProjectDescriptionColumn1747824239000
Starting migration AddLastActiveAtColumnToUser1750252139166
Finished migration AddLastActiveAtColumnToUser1750252139166

There is a deprecation related to your environment variables. Please take the recommended actions to update your configuration:
- N8N_RUNNERS_ENABLED -> Running n8n without task runners is deprecated. Task runners will be turned on by default in a future version. Please set 'N8N_RUNNERS_ENABLED=true' to enable task runners now and avoid potential issues in the future. Learn more: https://docs.n8n.io/hosting/configuration/task-runners/

[license SDK] Skipping renewal on init because renewal is not due yet or cert is not initialized
OIDC login is disabled.
Version: 1.102.4

Editor is now accessible via:
http://localhost:5678

Press "o" to open in Browser.
```

Once ready, you'll see something like:

```
Shell
Editor is now accessible via:
http://localhost:5678
```

♦ Step 3: Open the n8n workflow editor

Open your browser and go to the following url:

`http://localhost:5678`

You'll now see the n8n canvas UI where you can build workflows visually.

✅ OPTIONAL: Store Workflows Locally (Persistent Use)

By default, data is stored in memory and resets when you close the terminal. To persist workflows, follow these steps:

♦ Step 1: Create a .n8n folder

```
Shell
mkdir .n8n
```

♦ Step 2: Set data folder path when starting n8n

```
Shell
npx n8n --tunnel --data-folder=.n8n
```

You can also set up .env files or use n8n.config.js if you become more comfortable.

🛑 To Stop n8n

Simply go back to the Command Prompt window running n8n

Press Ctrl + C in the terminal to stop the server

```
C:\windows\system32\cmd.exe X + v
Starting migration AddWorkflowStatisticsRootCount1745587087521
Finished migration AddWorkflowStatisticsRootCount1745587087521
Starting migration AddWorkflowArchivedColumn1745934666076
Finished migration AddWorkflowArchivedColumn1745934666076
Starting migration DropRoleTable1745934666077
Finished migration DropRoleTable1745934666077
Starting migration AddProjectDescriptionColumn1747824239000
Finished migration AddProjectDescriptionColumn1747824239000
Starting migration AddLastActiveAtColumnToUser1750252139166
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[license SDK] Skipping renewal on init because renewal is not due yet or cert is not initialized
OIDC login is disabled.
Version: 1.102.4

Editor is now accessible via:
http://localhost:5678

Press "o" to open in Browser.
Received SIGINT. Shutting down...

Stopping n8n...

C:\Users\henry>
```